A PERSONAL INTEREST. A RELEASED PRODUCT.

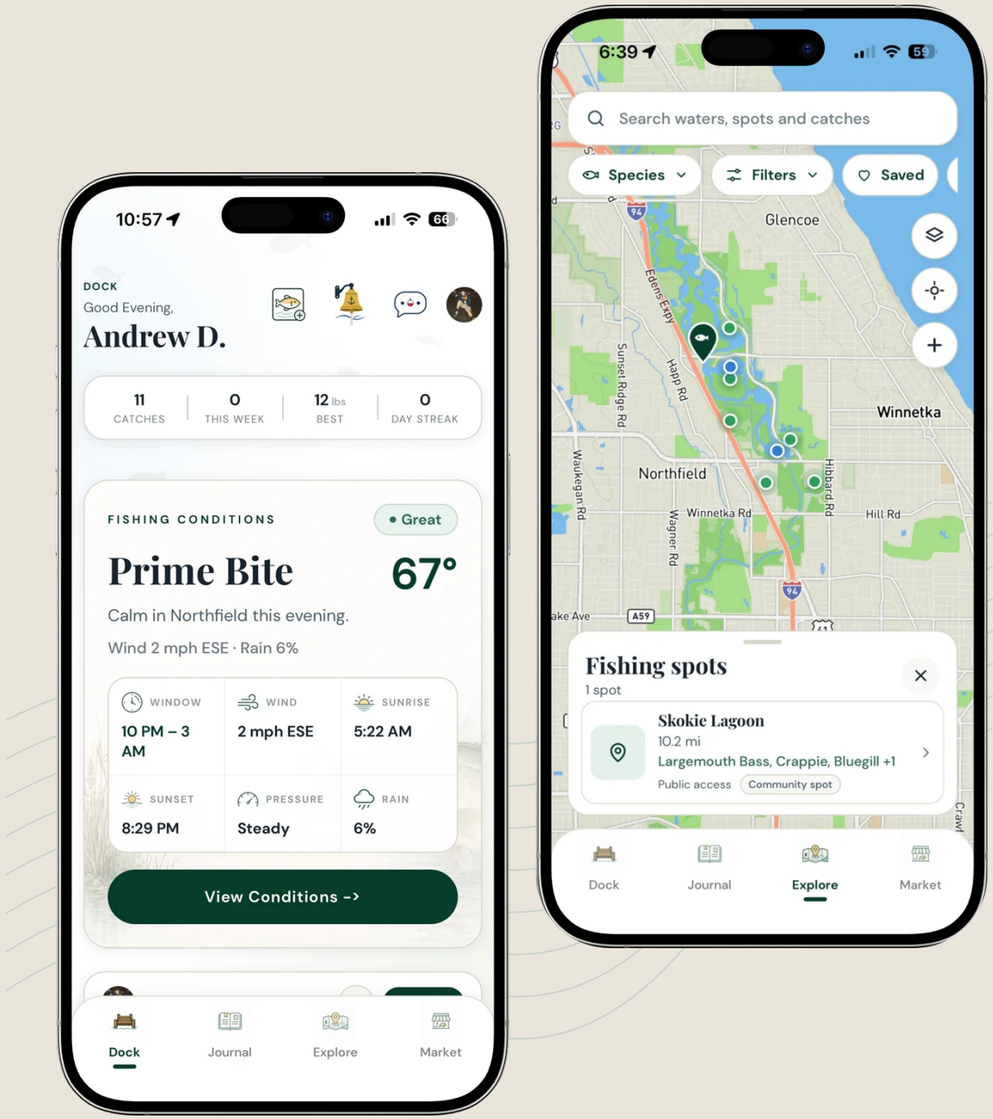
Backwater Journal

Every catch has a story.

A fishing app connecting personal records, nearby discovery and an angler community.

MY ROLE

Founder, product designer and mobile app developer



CURRENT WEBSITE PRODUCT-TOUR SCREENS

FROM FISHING INTEREST TO PRODUCT

I took the idea beyond the mockup.

Fishing gave me a reason to build something of my own. I designed and developed Backwater Journal as an iOS product, bringing its screens, navigation and supporting services into a working app.

01

Product direction

I shaped the experience around logging, discovery, community and fishing gear.

02

Interface + implementation

I worked across visual design and mobile development rather than stopping at static screens.

03

Release + refinement

The product was released on the App Store and has continued through a documented update.

PLATFORM

iOS / iPhone

INITIAL RELEASE

July 14, 2026

VERIFIED UPDATE

1.1.0 / September 27, 2026

AVAILABLE REGIONS

United States and Canada

TOOLS

Figma, React Native / Expo, Supabase, TestFlight

An independent product available on the App Store.

ONE PRODUCT, SEVERAL CONNECTED JOBS

Keep the fishing experience connected.

The design intent is to connect the moments before, during and after a trip without making every task feel the same.

01

Prepare

Dock + Explore

Conditions and nearby discovery.

02

Record

Catch Log + Journal

Structured records and personal stories.

03

Revisit

Species + catch history

A record that becomes useful over time.

04

Connect

Community + Market

Share experiences and coordinate gear trades.

TWO KINDS OF RECORDS

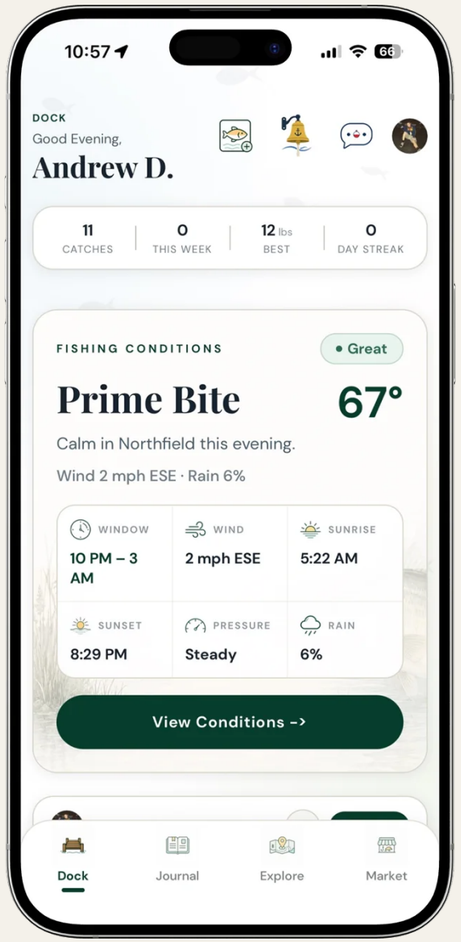
A catch log captures a single fish with structured details. A journal entry holds the notes, stories and updates that do not fit into those fields.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Keep structure where it helps people remember details; leave room for expression where the experience is personal.

PLANNING AND SHARING HAVE DIFFERENT JOBS

A useful starting point. A place to connect.



DOCK / CONDITIONS



DOCK / SHARED CATCH

01

Conditions at a glance

Dock brings the bite window, weather details and catch statistics into one opening view.

02

Catches become stories

The community experience pairs a shared catch with a photograph and key fishing details.

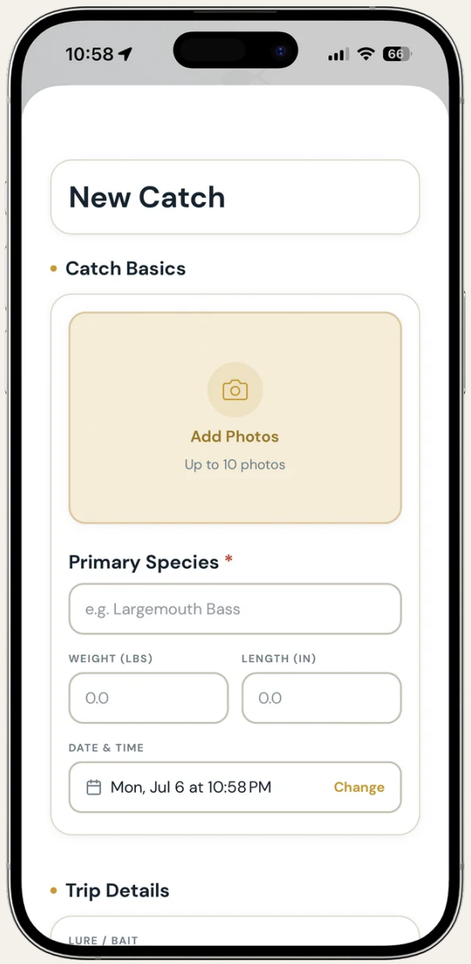
03

Keep the purpose clear

My design intent is to let practical information support the trip while community content adds a reason to return.

THE DETAILS WORTH REMEMBERING

Turn a catch into a useful record.



A STRUCTURED CAPTURE FLOW

The catch form supports photos, species, weight, length, date and time, alongside bait or lure and trip details. Photos and fields serve different purposes: the image remembers the moment, while the data supports later review.

01

Start with the catch

The visible form groups photographs and core facts before the trip details.

02

Support interrupted use

Version 1.1.0 added offline drafts, so recording work can be kept when connectivity is limited.

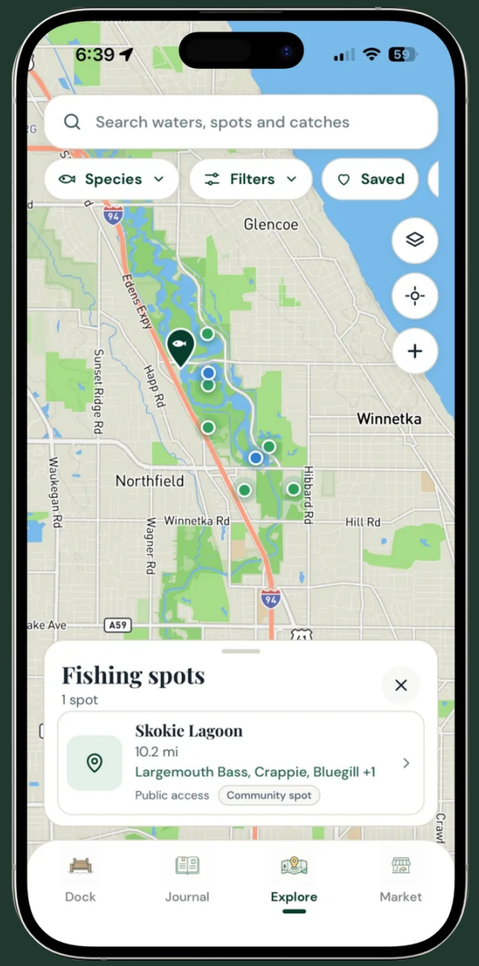
03

Keep history portable

The same release added catch-history export and measurement improvements.

THE MAP AS THE MAIN WORKSPACE

Make discovery easier to act on.



The current Explore screen leads with the map, then places search, species filters and saved access above it. A spot summary keeps the selected place connected to the map.

01

Search stays close

The search field names waters, spots and catches, making its scope visible.

02

The selected spot has context

A compact details panel sits above the bottom navigation rather than replacing the whole map.

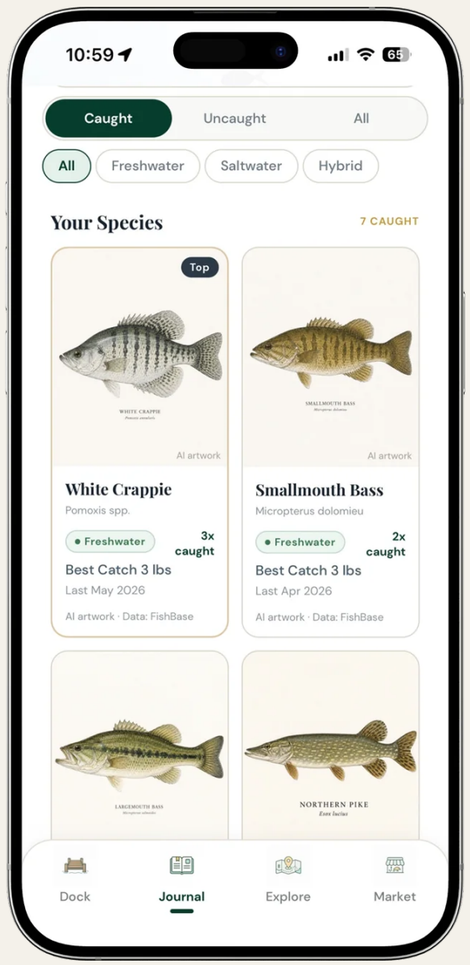
03

Refinement is documented

The 1.1.0 release describes improved discovery, saved spots, catch activity and map interactions.

GIVE THE RECORD A REASON TO GROW

From individual catches to a personal collection.



A different view of the same history

The species collection shows caught fish with catch counts and best catches. Filters separate caught and uncaught species and different water types.

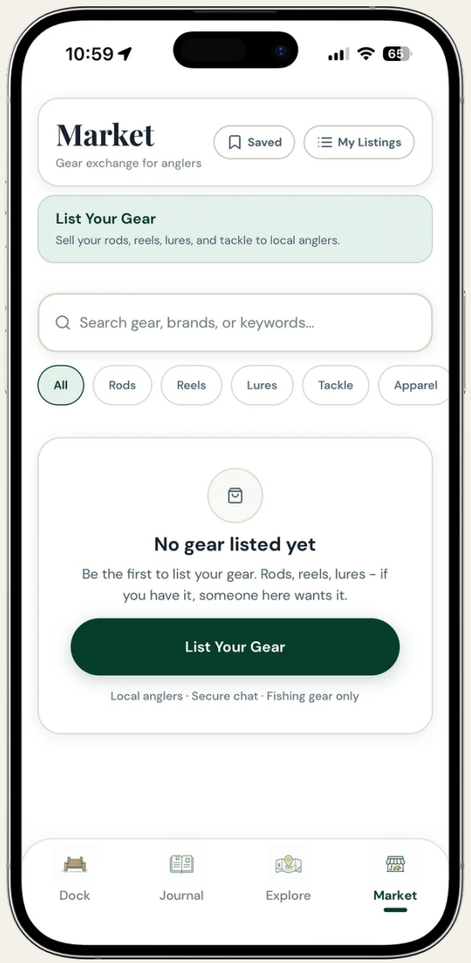
DESIGN INTENT

I want the journal to become more useful with each trip. A species view gives people another way to revisit their records without scrolling through every individual catch.

The counts visible in these screenshots belong to an example account. They are not evidence of app adoption or product performance.

A MARKETPLACE WITH CLEAR BOUNDARIES

Help people coordinate. State what the app handles.



Market supports gear search, categories, saved listings and creating a listing. Buyers and sellers message each other to arrange the transaction.

PRODUCT BOUNDARY

Backwater Journal does not process marketplace payments or provide buyer protection.

01

An empty state with a next step

The current screenshot shows no gear listed and offers a clear action to list gear. It does not imply a populated marketplace.

A PRODUCT THAT CONTINUED AFTER LAUNCH

The latest verified update changed the experience.

JULY 14, 2026

Initial release / 1.0

The App Store version history records the first public release.

SEPTEMBER 27, 2026

Refinement / 1.1.0

Explore was rebuilt, with additions to catch capture, portability and reliability.

01

Explore

Discovery, saved places, catch activity and map interactions.

02

Capture

Pin on Map, offline drafts and measurement improvements.

03

Ownership

Catch-history export.

04

Reliability

Privacy, performance and reliability improvements.

These are documented release changes. They do not establish improved task completion, retention or user satisfaction.

A FIELD-JOURNAL FEEL

Warm surfaces. Clear hierarchy. Room for the catch.

PRESENTATION PALETTE

Paper	Forest	Brass	Ink
#F4F1EA	#20382F	#D9A441	#1F2A24

Typography sets the pace.

Editorial serif headings bring character to this presentation. A quiet sans-serif keeps decisions, captions and product facts easy to scan.

MY PRESENTATION APPROACH

Large phone showcases, generous margins and subtle contour lines echo time on the water. Forest green anchors important sections; brass stays a restrained accent.

The palette is drawn from the current marketing site. Presentation typography is not a specification of every font used inside the app.

TRUST IS PART OF THE PRODUCT

Sensitive places. Shared content. Real people.

01

Location deserves care

The published privacy policy describes location-based features and device permission controls. Catch locations can be sensitive, so clear sharing choices matter.

02

Support needs a clear path

Public support includes bug reports, account and deletion requests, and marketplace safety concerns.

03

Community needs controls

Published support describes in-app reporting and blocking for listings, messages and accounts.

04

Validate the important tasks

My next evaluation would focus on catch logging, finding a spot and understanding what is shared. I would also check readability outdoors and accessibility on real devices.

No tester counts, usability scores, adoption figures or measured outcome claims are added to this case study.

FROM IDEA TO AN ONGOING PRODUCT

Shipping the app was a beginning.

I brought Backwater Journal through product design and mobile development into a released iOS app. The work connects a personal interest with the practical demands of a product people can download and use.

The product story connects records, maps, community and marketplace tools to different parts of fishing. My next step is to evaluate how clearly people can move between those experiences.

Keep the product useful.
Let evidence guide the next change.

SOURCE RECORD / OCT 14, 2026

Current product descriptions and screen assets

https://www.backwaterjournal.com/

App Store release history: 1.0 and 1.1.0

https://apps.apple.com/us/app/backwater-journal/id6761636518

Published privacy and support information

https://www.backwaterjournal.com/privacy/

https://www.backwaterjournal.com/support/

Public sources verify the released product. Design intent and next steps are presented separately from measured outcomes.